



EdgeTab

BlackBerry's "Productivity Edge" lives on – as an open-source build for any Android phone

This guide shows what the edge panel can do and how to set it up.

Version 0.75 · GNU GPLv3 · no BlackBerry code, only open Android interfaces

Source code & APK: github.com/8818freak/EdgeTab

All screenshots are from real use – personal names and content have been redacted. The app itself also supports English (follows the device language), but these particular screenshots were taken in German.

1 What is EdgeTab?

Anyone who misses their old BlackBerry knows the "Productivity Edge" – the narrow handle at the screen edge that, on a tap or a pull, shows a panel with calendar, inbox, contacts, tasks and more, without leaving the app you're in. BlackBerry discontinued this feature. EdgeTab rebuilds it from scratch – entirely original code, not a line from any BlackBerry app, talking only to public, documented Android interfaces (notification access, calendar/contacts providers, media session control, app widgets, JTX Board for tasks).

Free, open source (GNU GPLv3), no ads, no data collection. Runs in German and English (follows device language) on any Android device from version 10 onward – no BlackBerry device required.

The edge handle

A narrow, tapered handle sits at the screen edge (left or right, your choice) – just like the original. Tap or pull it to open the panel; swipe back or tap elsewhere to close it again. Height, position, width and transparency are all freely adjustable.

2 Settings

The Settings tab always sits at the top of the tab column and is split into short categories instead of one long list. Changes take effect immediately, no restart needed.

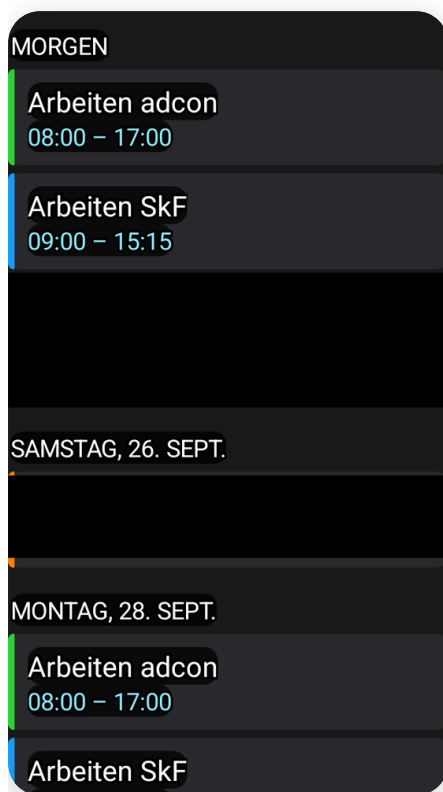
Managing tabs

Every tab can be switched on/off, renamed, given its own icon (from the photo gallery or a bundled symbol), and reordered via ▲▼. Any number of "Widget" and "Shortcuts" tabs can be created – for example, a separate tab per chat group of shortcuts.

Position & appearance

Side (left/right), handle height and vertical position, width of the extended panel, transparency, font size, and the icon size of the tab column – all via sliders. The fixed position of the media-control buttons (top/middle/bottom) is also set here, for one-handed use.

3 Calendar

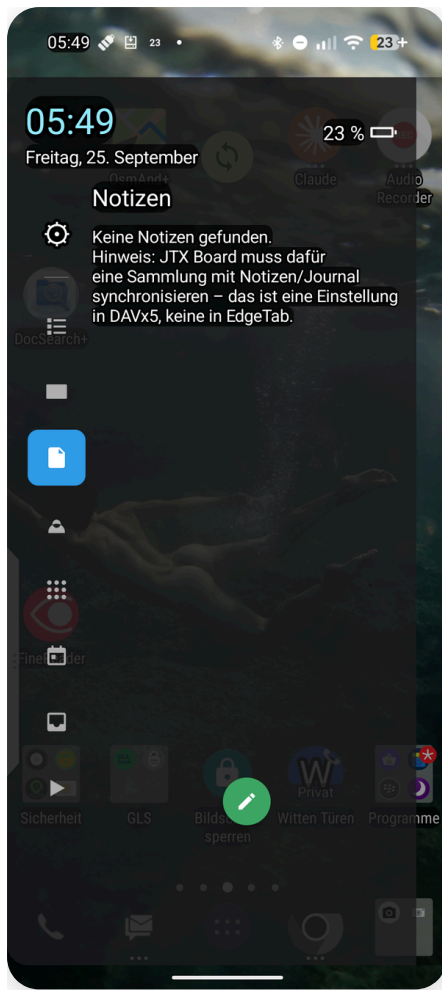


Shows upcoming events from the system calendar, grouped by day (TODAY/TOMORROW/weekday), with a colored bar per calendar. Tapping an event opens it directly; the pencil button at the bottom opens the system calendar app's own "new event" screen – deliberately not a slimmed-down recreation, but the real, full app.

Real calendar view – personal event names and addresses have been redacted for this guide.

4 Tasks & Notes

EdgeTab has no task server of its own – instead it reads and writes to the open content provider of JTX Board, which itself syncs with any CalDAV server via DAVx⁵. No lock-in, no proprietary cloud.



Tasks

Due tasks with a date, checkable directly – completion is written back to JTX Board and syncs onward normally.

Notes

Journal entries from the same JTX Board collection. No notes app yet? The pencil button hands off directly to ImapNotes3 (open source, syncs notes over an IMAP mailbox) – a tap opens a fresh, empty note there right away.

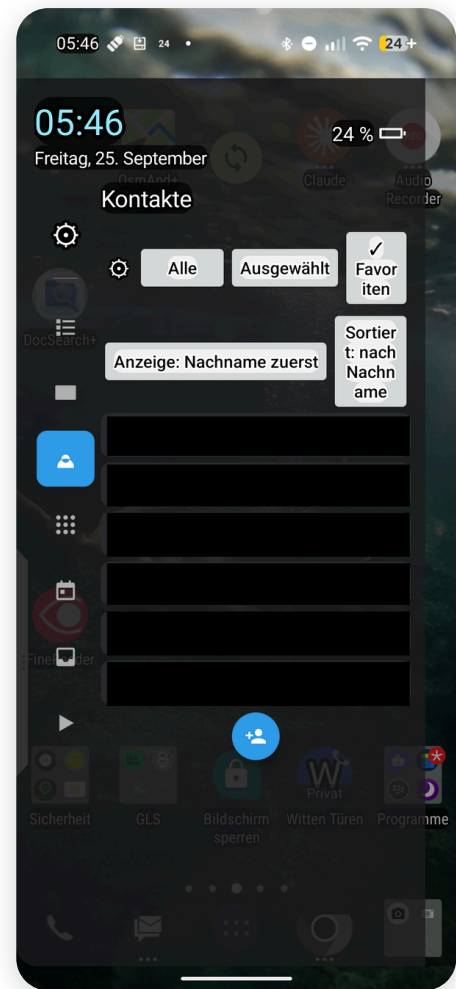
One-time setup: install JTX Board, connect it to your own CalDAV account (e.g. via DAVx⁵), then enter the account name once in EdgeTab.

5 Contacts

Shows all contacts, a freely assembled selection, or only the ones marked as favorites – with photo, straight from the system address book. Tapping a contact opens it in the system contacts app. The "Selected" mode allows a hand-picked list of your own – handy for your most important contacts, independent of "Favorite".

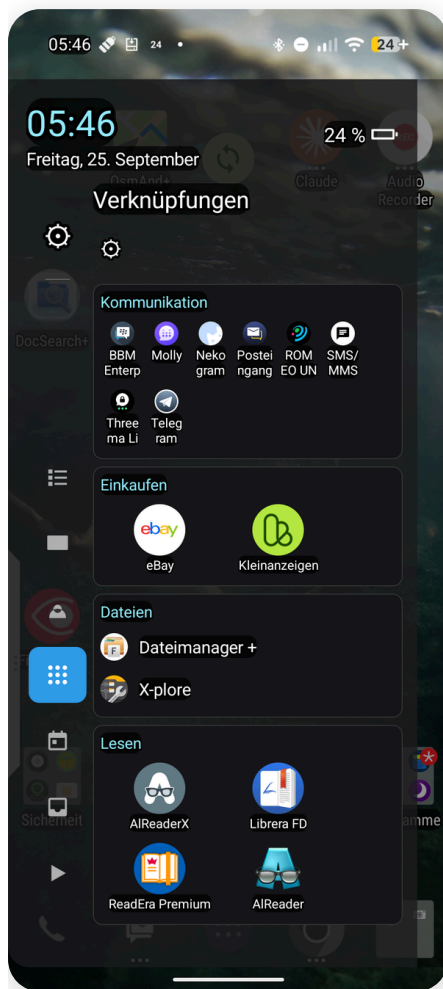
Display and sorting set independently

Whether first or last name is *shown* first, and whether the list is *sorted* by first or last name, can be changed independently of each other – via the two switches in the card's header.



Names and photos redacted for this guide.

6 Shortcuts



A freely designed home screen for app icons – sorted into any number of freely named groups, each group with its own view (grid with adjustable column count, or list) and its own visible frame.

Multiple groups in a grid – here "Communication", "Shopping", "Files" and "Reading", each with its own frame.

Reordering groups and entries

In edit mode, every group (once there is more than one) gets its own ▲▼ arrows to move it as a whole, and every individual entry additionally gets its own ▲▼ arrows for its position within the group. Also available: grid/list switch with column count, renaming, and removal (X) per entry.

Adding several apps at once

The gear icon's "+ Add app" opens a searchable list of all installed apps. Check several at once and commit them together with "Add (n)", instead of tapping each app in one at a time.

7 App widgets

Any app widget that would otherwise sit on the home screen can be embedded directly into the panel – for example the BlackBerry Hub inbox, a weather widget, or DAVx⁵'s sync button. The picker list shows every widget available on the device, grouped by app.

8 Media control

Shows all active playback sessions (music, audiobooks, podcasts) with cover art, title and artist – back/play-pause/forward controllable directly, without opening the app at all. A fixed quick-control bar (top/middle/bottom, your choice) stays in the same place while scrolling, for one-handed thumb reach from the hand holding the phone.

9 Inbox



Collects notifications from the chosen apps – works with BlackBerry Hub, Telegram, Signal, SMS and practically any other app that posts notifications. Reply (with or without inline text entry, depending on what the source app offers) and delete trigger the real action in the source app itself. A category bar at the top of the card filters the view by the categories assigned below it – it only appears once at least two different categories have been assigned (with only one, or none, it stays hidden).

*Category bar in the inbox itself – here "All" / "Communication" / "Shopping".
Names redacted for this guide.*

Sources, categories, channels

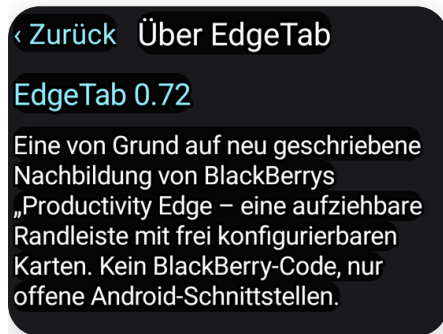
Every source app can be switched on/off individually and assigned a category (Communication, News, Shopping, Finance, Productivity, Entertainment, Other ...) – the category colors the entry in the inbox and enables a quick filter there. For apps with several notification types (e.g. eBay: "messages" vs. "new listings"), individual channels can be turned off selectively.

Entries stay visible in the inbox even once the system notification itself is long gone – reply/ delete then only work as long as Android still holds on to the original action (a limit of the Android platform itself, not an EdgeTab restriction).

10 Screen rotation

In landscape or on a short screen, the tab icon column can hold more entries than fit at once. That column is its own scroll zone: the settings gear at the top always stays fixed in place, while every card icon below it scrolls independently. If the bar is rotated while the panel is open, EdgeTab automatically rebuilds the whole panel from scratch – this fixes rendering glitches in embedded widgets that could otherwise show up at the wrong height after rotating.

11 About EdgeTab



Its own entry in the settings menu shows the version number, the license text, and – expandable – the full changelog right inside the app, with no need to open GitHub for it.

License: **GNU General Public License v3** (or later). No BlackBerry code, no third-party libraries – only open Android system interfaces.

✓ Getting started

EdgeTab is free and open source (GNU GPLv3). Source code, build instructions and a ready-made, signed APK are available on GitHub – no Gradle needed, just the raw Android SDK command-line tools:

github.com/8818freak/EdgeTab

- Notification access and calendar/contacts permission are requested on first launch or as needed – nothing runs without consent.
- No ads, no tracking, no cloud connection beyond the services you set up yourself (JTX Board, ImapNotes3, app widgets).
- Questions, ideas, bugs? Feel free to report them directly on GitHub.

EdgeTab is a hobby project, not an official BlackBerry product and not affiliated with BlackBerry Ltd.